

A For playing games that have been coming out in the past year or two, you should really consider a completely new system. Your two big upgrades—keeping the rest of the system the same—are the memory and graphics card. Add at least a GB of RAM and upgrade to a decent AGP card, like a GeForce 7600GT or an ATI Radeon x1800 or x1900 series. We'd still recommend a complete system overhaul though.

Motherboard For PC Config

Q I want to upgrade my system with the following configuration: Intel Core 2 Quad Q6600 Processor, 2 GB DDR2 RAM Transcend. I'm currently having 250 GB HDD + 17-inch monitor. I just want to know, which motherboard is best suited for my configuration, as I don't want to go for graphics card right now. I selected the Intel G33 TL chipset, but according to online surveys, it doesn't perform too well. So please suggest a motherboard, with an on-board graphics solution, that's suitable enough to run Vista Ultimate without problems. I do not want a gaming rig. Also, suggest a motherboard that will be available in India over the next month. My overall budget is Rs 20,000 (including Processor + RAM)

Aashish Jindal

A Your processor and memory is more than sufficient to run Windows Vista. The G33 might not have the best onboard graphics solution, but adding a dedicated graphics card will increase the performance phenomenally. You could also add another 2 GB of memory. If you spend a lot of time gaming, then a GeForce 9600 GSO, 9600 GT or an 8800 GT would be great cards to buy. They are priced between Rs 7,000 to Rs 12,000. If you just want something that is Vista-compatible, then a GeForce 8400 GS or an ATI Radeon 2400 XT will do. Unfortunately, we cannot recommend that you use onboard graphics with a Q6600 and 2/4 GB of RAM for Vista Ultimate—that's just criminal!

USB Problem

Q I have a problem regarding the USB slot of my PC, which I think you guys will surely sort out.

Actually, the problem is, when I connect any pen drive to any USB port,